Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A 8 4
♥ A 8 7 3
♦ 10 9 5
♣ 7 5 2

♠ 10 7 3
♥ Q J 10 2
♦ 8 6 2
♣ J 4 3

♠ 5 2
♥ K 9 6 5
♦ A 4 3
♣ 10 9 8 6

♠ K Q J 9 6
♥ 4
♦ K Q J 7
♣ A K Q

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

6♠ by South
Lead: ♥Q

2NT shows a balanced hand with 8+ points, and when NORTH then supports ♠s SOUTH makes a slam try.

SOUTH bids RKC Blackwood 4NT. NORTH shows two Keycards (two Aces) and SOUTH bids 6♠.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K J ♥ Q J 8 5 ♦ Q 10 9 7 ♣ Q 4 2	
♠ 6 5 4 3 ♥ A 3 ♦ A 5 2 ♣ 10 9 7 5		♠ 10 9 8 2 ♥ 9 6 ♦ 8 6 4 ♣ J 8 6 3
	♠ A Q 7 ♥ K 10 7 4 2 ♦ K J 3 ♣ A K	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	5♥
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 0 or 3 key cards

5♥ by South
Lead: ♣10

NORTH has a decent Limit Raise, and SOUTH tries RKC Blackwood.

NORTH replies to the 4NT bid with 5♦, zero or three Keycards. So which is it, zero or three?

Pretty simple - since SOUTH holds three Keycards himself NORTH can hardly have three also since there are only five total. She must have zero and SOUTH signs off at 5♥.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K 10 7 4 ♥ K Q J 8 4 ♦ A 6 ♣ A 3	
♠ 9 5 ♥ 10 9 7 6 ♦ J 9 4 3 2 ♣ 7 6		♠ J ♥ A 3 2 ♦ 10 8 5 ♣ J 10 9 8 4 2
	♠ A Q 8 6 3 2 ♥ 5 ♦ K Q 7 ♣ K Q 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	1♠
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 0 or 3 key cards

6♠ by South
Lead: ♣7

NORTH jumps to 4♠, confident that SOUTH could make 10 tricks even if he just has 6 points.

SOUTH knows he can make more and bids RKCB 4NT.

NORTH's 5♦ response shows zero or three Keycards. So which is it? Zero or three?

NORTH bid much too strongly to have no Aces. SOUTH bids a confident 6♠, knowing NORTH has either three Aces or two Aces plus the ♠K.

Board 4
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 7 5 ♥ Q 10 8 3 ♦ A 8 5 4 ♣ 9 2	
♠ Q 10 8 4 2 ♥ 2 ♦ Q J 7 3 ♣ 8 7 4		♠ K J 9 3 ♥ J 6 ♦ K 10 9 2 ♣ A 6 5
	♠ 6 ♥ A K 9 7 5 4 ♦ 6 ♣ K Q J 10 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♠[2]	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣4

With eleven cards in the "round" suits SOUTH has a lot of playing strength. So when NORTH bids a Limit Raise in ♥s SOUTH wants to know about Aces.

RKCBlackwood tells him that NORTH has two Aces plus the trump Queen, so SOUTH can see that 6♥ is practically a certainty.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ Q J 7 3 ♥ A J 5 ♦ 10 6 3 2 ♣ K 4	
♠ 10 ♥ 9 7 4 2 ♦ A J 5 ♣ Q 9 8 7 6		♠ 6 5 ♥ 8 3 ♦ K Q 9 7 ♣ J 10 5 3 2
	♠ A K 9 8 4 2 ♥ K Q 10 6 ♦ 8 4 ♣ A	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♥	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♥4

SOUTH has interest in slam after she hears NORTH's Limit Raise. BUT, she should not use Blackwood holding two quick losers in the ♦ suit.

Instead she makes a Control showing bid of 4♣. (Not Gerber since it didn't follow a NT bid.)

NORTH cooperates by making a Control bid of 4♥.

SOUTH stops at 4♠ because neither partner controls ♦s.

Board 6
North Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 6 ♥ K Q 8 7 2 ♦ A K 9 6 3 ♣ K Q	
♠ K 9 8 5 3 ♥ A 9 5 ♦ 4 2 ♣ J 8 7		♠ Q 10 4 2 ♥ 10 4 3 ♦ 5 ♣ 10 9 5 3 2
	♠ A J 7 ♥ J 6 ♦ Q J 10 8 7 ♣ A 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	2♦
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]
Pass	6♦		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♦ by South
Lead: ♣7

NORTH decides it is unlikely that SOUTH is Aceless, so all he wants to know is the number of Aces SOUTH does have. He invokes RKC Blackwood.

Since no trump suit has been agreed, SOUTH bids as if ♦s, the last-bid suit prior to 4NT is agreed. SOUTH has two Key-cards plus the trump Queen, so she bids 5♠.

NORTH bids 6♦. If SOUTH had just one Key-card, NORTH would bid 5♦ over the 5♣ reply.

Board 7
North Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 6 ♥ K Q 8 7 2 ♦ K Q ♣ A K 9 6 3	
♠ A J 10 4 ♥ A 9 ♦ 9 8 7 5 3 2 ♣ 2		♠ 9 8 5 3 2 ♥ 10 5 4 3 ♦ J 10 ♣ 5 4
	♠ K Q 7 ♥ J 6 ♦ A 6 4 ♣ Q J 10 8 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	2♣
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

5♣ by South
Lead: ♥A

This is the companion to Deal 6. The cards are the same except that the ♦s and ♣s have been swapped.

Again, NORTH has no problem as long as SOUTH holds at least one Key-card. When SOUTH responds 5♣, (showing one Key-card), NORTH can pass.

That's what happens here.

Board 8
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K Q J 8 7 5 2 ♥ 4 ♦ K 6 ♣ A K 5	
♠ 4 ♥ 9 7 5 2 ♦ 9 5 4 3 ♣ 8 7 4 2	N W E S	♠ 10 3 ♥ A K 8 6 ♦ 10 8 7 2 ♣ 10 6 3
	♠ A 9 6 ♥ Q J 10 3 ♦ A Q J ♣ Q J 9	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

6♠ by South
Lead: ♣4

NORTH needs to know how many Aces SOUTH holds.

One way to find out would be to bid 3♠, (which is forcing), then launch Blackwood.

Another way is to bid 4♣ (Gerber) right now.

The first way is probably better but we needed a Gerber example.

Board 9
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A J 10 5
♥ A K
♦ K 5
♣ A K Q J 4

♠ 9 6
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ A 10 8 6 2
♣ 10 3

♠ 2
♥ J 10 9 3
♦ Q J 9 7 4 3
♣ 8 5

♠ K Q 8 7 4 3
♥ Q 7 5
♦ —
♣ 9 7 6 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♦
Pass	7♠		
All Pass			

7♠ by South
Lead: ♦A

SOUTH's positive response shows 8+ points and five or more cards headed by at least two honors.

NORTH figures a small slam would be safe, but just to be sure she uses Blackwood.

SOUTH's 6♦ reply shows one Key-card which must be the trump King, and a ♦ void!.

NORTH readjusts her thinking and decides to bid the Grand.

Board 10
North Deals
Both Vul

	♠ K Q 3 ♥ K 10 9 3 ♦ A 6 ♣ K Q 9 6	
♠ 10 9 5 4 ♥ 6 4 ♦ 5 2 ♣ J 10 5 4 2		♠ J 8 7 2 ♥ J ♦ J 10 9 8 7 4 ♣ A 3
	♠ A 6 ♥ A Q 8 7 5 2 ♦ K Q 3 ♣ 8 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♥ by South
Lead: ♦5

SOUTH jumps in ♥s, showing a good suit and slam interest.

NORTH has great ♥ support so bids RKCB 4NT.

SOUTH responds 5♠, showing two Key Cards and the ♥Q.

That is enough for NORTH to bid the slam.

Board 11
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A Q 6 4 ♥ A K Q ♦ A 5 ♣ K J 6 3	
♠ J 8 ♥ 10 6 5 3 2 ♦ Q 10 4 ♣ 10 8 7	N W E S	♠ 9 ♥ J 9 7 4 ♦ J 9 7 3 2 ♣ 9 5 2
	♠ K 10 7 5 3 2 ♥ 8 ♦ K 8 6 ♣ A Q 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♣	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 0 or 3 key cards

7NT by South
Lead: ♥6

When NORTH agrees to ♠s, SOUTH will not stop short of a slam. The RKCB 4NT bid tells SOUTH that they have all five Key Cards since NORTH could hardly have a 2♣ opening hand with no Aces.

SOUTH's 5♥ bid is the Queen Ask, and NORTH's reply confirms that she holds the ♠Q, and also has the ♣K.

SOUTH figures the ♠ suit will run, and this should be enough for Grand Slam. He chooses 7NT.

Board 12
North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ Q 8 6
♥ Q J 3
♦ A J 5
♣ A J 6 5

♠ J 2
♥ A K 7 5 4
♦ 10 8 4
♣ 10 8 7

♠ 10 9 4
♥ 10 9 6 2
♦ 9 6 3
♣ 9 3 2

♠ A K 7 5 3
♥ 8
♦ K Q 7 2
♣ K Q 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♠[2]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♠ by South
Lead: ♥K

SOUTH knows there are enough points for slam, but she is worried about the trump suit. NORTH's support doesn't guarantee more than three ♠s, and if they are not headed by the Queen she could lose a trump trick.

Her RKCB bid relieves her mind when SOUTH claims two Key Cards PLUS the ♠Q. She bids 6♠ (and hopes for a 3-2 trump split!).

Board 13
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 9 3
♥ A 10 6
♦ A 9 8 6 2
♣ K 9

♠ 8 7
♥ J 7 5
♦ 10 7 4 3
♣ Q J 7 3

♠ 10 4
♥ Q 9 4 3
♦ K J 5
♣ 10 6 4 2

♠ A Q J 6 5 2
♥ K 8 2
♦ Q
♣ A 8 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 0 or 3 key cards

6♠ by South
Lead: ♣Q

When SOUTH makes a slam try with a jump to 3♠, the best approach for NORTH is to agree on the trump suit immediately but indicate a minimum hand by bidding 4♠.

SOUTH's next move is logical; RKCB 4NT.

NORTH shows zero or three Key Cards, and since it could not possibly be zero, SOUTH knows they are the ♠K and both red Aces. Even possessing all the Key Cards SOUTH knows there aren't enough points for a Grand slam.

Board 14
North Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 5
♥ A K 9 8 7 4 2
♦ 7 3
♣ 8 7

♠ Q J 10 7 3
♥ 5
♦ 10 8 4
♣ Q 10 5 3

♠ 8 6 4 2
♥ 10 6
♦ J 9 6 2
♣ K J 4

♠ A K
♥ Q J 3
♦ A K Q 5
♣ A 9 6 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

7NT by South
Lead: ♠Q

It is usually not recommended to use any form of Blackwood when you have a suit with two quick losers, but SOUTH knows NORTH would not preempt with a 10-high ♥ suit.

NORTH's reply to RKCB is 5♥, showing two Key Cards. SOUTH knows they are the ♥A ♥K so she can count thirteen tricks.

She bids a confident 7NT (and hopes NORTH didn't open 3♥ with a 6-card suit.

Board 15
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ J 9 6 4 3 ♥ A Q 3 ♦ Q 7 ♣ Q 5 3	
♠ A 2 ♥ 10 8 2 ♦ J 9 4 2 ♣ 10 6 4 2	N W E S	♠ K ♥ J 9 7 5 4 ♦ 10 8 6 5 ♣ 9 8 7
	♠ Q 10 8 7 5 ♥ K 6 ♦ A K 3 ♣ A K J	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	5♠
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

5♠ by South
Lead: ♣4

SOUTH has 21 points, and when she hears NORTH make a limit raise she tries for slam with RKCB.

NORTH answers with just one Key Card so SOUTH stops at 5♠, knowing they are missing two Key Cards.

Of course she didn't expect the two missing Key Cards to be the Ace and King of trumps!

Board 16
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K Q 5 ♥ A Q 9 6 ♦ 7 6 4 ♣ K 9 6	
♠ 9 8 7 ♥ 10 8 2 ♦ J 8 2 ♣ Q 10 7 3		♠ 10 4 3 2 ♥ J 4 3 ♦ A 10 9 ♣ 8 4 2
	♠ A J 6 ♥ K 7 5 ♦ K Q 5 3 ♣ A J 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	1♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	4NT		
All Pass			

4NT by South
Lead: ♠9

What is this doing here in the RKCB Practice Pages?

To emphasize that there are many 4NT bids which are NOT asking for Aces.

In this case, SOUTH showed a balanced hand with 18 or 19 points, and NORTH invited him to bid 6NT if he felt his hand was a "maximum". He didn't, so he passed.

Board 17
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 9 7 2 ♥ Q J 5 3 ♦ Q J 7 5 3 ♣ —	
♠ Q 8 6 ♥ 8 ♦ 10 9 4 2 ♣ A K 10 8 2		♠ J 10 4 3 ♥ 10 4 ♦ A 6 ♣ Q J 9 5 3
	♠ K 5 ♥ A K 9 7 6 2 ♦ K 8 ♣ 7 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	4♣	Pass	4NT
Pass	6♣	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣K

When NORTH makes a Splinter bid, showing ♥ support and ♣ shortness, SOUTH naturally thinks about slam.

She uses RKCB 4NT, and NORTH, with one Key Card and a ♣ Void, bids 6♣.

Just what SOUTH needed for the 6♥ bid.

Board 18
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K 6 3 ♥ K Q 10 4 ♦ K Q 8 5 ♣ 2	
♠ 7 4 ♥ J 8 2 ♦ J 10 9 7 ♣ A 7 5 4		♠ J 10 5 ♥ 7 6 3 ♦ 3 2 ♣ 10 9 8 6 3
	♠ Q 9 8 2 ♥ A 9 5 ♦ A 6 4 ♣ K Q J	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♠ by South
Lead: ♦J

NORTH thinks they should be in slam, and uses Stayman to check for a 4-4 Major fit.

When SOUTH announces four ♠s NORTH uses RKCB 4NT.

SOUTH's 5♠ bid shows two Key Cards plus the ♠Q.

This fills the holes in NORTH's hand nicely, so she bids 6♠.

Board 19
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 6 3
♥ K Q 10 4
♦ K Q 8 5
♣ 2

♠ 10 7 5
♥ J 2
♦ 9 6 2
♣ A 10 9 7 3

♠ Q 4
♥ 8 7 6 3
♦ 10 7 3
♣ 8 6 5 4

♠ J 9 8 2
♥ A 9 5
♦ A J 4
♣ K Q J

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	5♠		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

5♠ by South
Lead: ♦2

This is the companion hand to Deal 18.

Again, NORTH uses RKCB after the 4-4 ♠ fit is discovered. This time SOUTH shows two Key Cards without the ♠Q.

Now NORTH realizes that in addition to one outside Ace, there is a very possible loser in trumps. So she stops at 5♠.

Board 20
North Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 7 3 2 ♥ A K Q 8 6 4 ♦ 5 3 ♣ 8 7	
♠ J 9 6 5 ♥ 10 7 ♦ Q J 9 8 ♣ K 10 3		♠ Q 10 8 ♥ 3 2 ♦ 10 4 2 ♣ Q J 9 6 2
	♠ A K 4 ♥ J 9 5 ♦ A K 7 6 ♣ A 5 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♦Q

The chances of a slam on this hand are very small, and if SOUTH decides to use RKCB it will just confuse matters when NORTH shows two Key Cards.

SOUTH has a better way to find out about the hand. She bids 2NT asking NORTH to further describe his hand. NORTH should then bid 3NT, showing a solid suit headed by AKQ.

NORTH cannot have as much as an extra Jack, so SOUTH just passes 3NT.

Board 21
South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K 5 3
♥ A 9 5 2
♦ 8 5 4
♣ 6 5 4

♠ 9 4
♥ J 8 4
♦ 9 7 6
♣ K Q 9 8 2

♠ 10 7
♥ 10 6 3
♦ A 10 3 2
♣ J 10 7 3

♠ A Q J 8 6 2
♥ K Q 7
♦ K Q J
♣ A

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

6♠ by South
Lead: ♠9

SOUTH realizes NORTH has fewer than 8 points, but the 3♠ support bid is enough for her to try a RKCB 4NT bid.

NORTH shows two Key Cards and SOUTH figures they will be the ♠K and one of the red Aces. So she bids 6♠. If instead the Key Cards are the two red Aces SOUTH might possibly make all thirteen tricks with a finesse.

Board 22
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 7 2 ♥ Q 7 4 ♦ 9 8 5 ♣ 9 8 4 3	
♠ 10 6 3 ♥ 10 9 3 ♦ A J 3 2 ♣ J 10 2		♠ 9 8 4 ♥ J 8 ♦ K Q 10 7 4 ♣ 7 6 5
	♠ K Q J 5 ♥ A K 6 5 2 ♦ 6 ♣ A K Q	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	5♦
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣J

NORTH's 3♥ bid is "encouraging" so SOUTH bids 4NT.

When NORTH shows one Key Card, (an Ace), SOUTH is afraid he may have a trump loser as well the other Ace. To find out about the ♥Q he bids 5♦, the Queen Ask.

NORTH has the ♥Q but no King so she jumps to 6♥.

Board 23
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 7 2 ♥ J 9 8 7 4 ♦ 8 5 ♣ 8 4 3	
♠ 9 8 3 ♥ 10 3 ♦ Q J 7 4 ♣ J 10 7 6		♠ 10 6 4 ♥ Q ♦ A K 10 9 3 2 ♣ 9 5 2
	♠ K Q J 5 ♥ A K 6 5 2 ♦ 6 ♣ A K Q	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	5♦
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣J

This is the companion to Deal 22.

Again, worried about a possible trump loser in addition to the missing Ace, SOUTH bids 5♦, the Queen Ask.

NORTH definitely does NOT have the ♥Q. But with five trumps she does know that SOUTH probably does not have a trump loser so she jumps to 6♥ anyway.

Board 24
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K 9 6 3 ♥ A J 7 5 ♦ K Q 2 ♣ 6	
♠ J 7 2 ♥ 10 8 ♦ J 9 8 6 4 ♣ 10 7 3	N W E S	♠ Q 10 4 ♥ 3 2 ♦ A 10 5 ♣ Q J 9 4 2
	♠ 8 5 ♥ K Q 9 6 4 ♦ 7 3 ♣ A K 8 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♥ by South
Lead: ♦4

NORTH cannot use RKCB at her second bid because trumps have not been agreed. So she bids 3♥ to set trumps, knowing SOUTH cannot pass after her jump-shift.

SOUTH tries to stop at game but NORTH is too strong so she now uses RKCB and gets to 6♥ when SOUTH shows two Key Cards and the trump Queen.